The latest companies to reach $1B, checked

As of 6 November 2026. Each figure was searched by one researcher and re-checked by a separate fact-checker. I then opened the most important sources myself. Use this file as the only source for company figures in the deck, memo and six-pager.

Labels: Confirmed = company release, filing or a law firm on the deal. Reported = a reputable outlet. Estimate = a tracker or our arithmetic. Not disclosed = no reliable figure exists, so none is shown.

The market

- 195 companies joined the Crunchbase Unicorn Board in the first half of 2026, more than the 193 in all of 2025 (Crunchbase News, 10 Aug 2026). Confirmed.
- The US had 110 of them (56%), China 38 and the UK 13.
- A secondary source says AI accounts for more than a quarter of 2026's new unicorns. Treat as weak.

The newest $1B class

Company	What it does	First $1B	Latest value	Staff	Revenue	Sold to or through
Rillet	AI accounting system for finance teams	$1B, Aug 2026	$1B	Not disclosed	Not disclosed; 600+ customers	Direct, plus accounting firms as partners
Emergent	Builds apps from text (India)	$1.5B, Jul 2026	$1.5B	Not confirmed	About $120M a year, company-reported	Self-serve
Avoca	AI call agents for plumbers and heating firms	$1B, Apr 2026	$1B	Not disclosed	Not disclosed; 800+ customers	Direct to owners
Slash	Business banking for niche sellers	$1.4B, Apr 2026	$1.4B	Not disclosed	$250M annualised, CEO-stated	Direct, one niche at a time
Wonderful	Customer-service agents in 35+ markets	$2B, Mar 2026	$5B, Sep 2026	About 350 at $2B, reported	Not confirmed	Direct, with deployment engineers
Basis	AI agents for accounting firms	$1.15B, Feb 2026	$1.15B	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	Accounting firms only
Serval	AI IT service desk	$1B, Dec 2025	$3B, Oct 2026	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	Direct to companies
Tide	Business accounts for micro firms	$1.5B, Sep 2025	$1.5B	Not disclosed	Not confirmed	Direct and partners
Lovable	Builds apps from text (Sweden)	$1.8B, Jul 2025	$13.3B, Aug 2026	146 at $400M a year	$400M+, Feb 2026	Self-serve

Sources: [Rillet, TechCrunch](https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/19/rillet-raises-100m-series-c-at-1b-valuation-2-years-after-emerging-from-stealth/), [Emergent, TNW](https://thenextweb.com/news/emergent-130m-series-c-vibe-coding-unicorn), [Avoca](https://www.avoca.ai/blog/avoca-raises-125m-series-b-1b-valuation), [Slash, SiliconANGLE](https://siliconangle.com/2026/04/16/slash-raises-100m-1.4b-valuation-expand-ai-powered-banking-platform-online-businesses/), [Wonderful, TechCrunch](https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/02/wonderful-more-than-doubles-its-valuation-to-5b-in-under-6-months/), [Basis, Business Wire](https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260224020999/en/Basis-Raises-$100M-at-a-$1.15B-Valuation-as-Accounting-Firms-Adopt-End-to-End-Agents-Across-Accounting,-Tax,-and-Audit), [Serval, Fortune](https://fortune.com/2026/10/29/serval-servicenow-fight-series-c-3-billion-valuation-sequoia/), [Tide, tech.eu](https://tech.eu/2025/09/22/uk-business-bank-tide-attains-unicorn-status-with-120-funding-round/), [Lovable, tech.eu](https://tech.eu/2026/08/12/lovables-valuation-doubles-to-13bn-as-raises-400m/).

Closest to NowAI: accountants as the channel

Company	Country	Value	Clients	Notes
Pennylane	France	About $4.25B, Jan 2026 (Bloomberg; Maddyness gives EUR 3.5B)	About 800,000 firms through about 6,000 accounting partners (deal adviser, reported)	About EUR 115M a year in 2025 (Maddyness). First about EUR 1B in Feb 2024. Mandatory e-invoicing from Sep 2026 helped.
Basis	US	$1.15B, Feb 2026	About 30% of the top 25 US firms (company claim)	About $138M raised. Sells only to accounting firms.
Rillet	US	$1B, Aug 2026	600+ customers	More than $200M raised. Won accounting firms as partners.
DataSnipper	Netherlands	$1B, Feb 2024	All Big Four	About 130 staff at $1B (Fortune, read directly). A plug-in inside Excel.
Omie	Brazil	About $700M pre-money, 2025 round	About 180,000	About R$600M a year (Startups.com.br). Mostly a share sale. Founded about 2013. Investors named the accountant channel as the asset. Now adding banking, credit and payments.
Conta Azul	Brazil	About $300M sale to Visma, Aug 2025 (Bloomberg; price undisclosed)	About 100,000 (Visma)	Founded 2011. Software fees only.
Paraşüt	Turkey	Sold to DST in 2019, price undisclosed	11,000+	Now part of the Mikro group.
Clear (ClearTax)	India	$700M+, 2021	Not found	No new priced round since. Losses and layoffs reported.

The money layer

Company	Finding	Label
Toast	About 82% of 2025 revenue from fintech, 15% from subscriptions	Confirmed, annual report
Melio	Bought by Xero for $2.5B upfront, 80,000 customers, $153M revenue FY25	Confirmed, Xero
Gusto	$9.3B (June 2025 tender offer). Passed $1B cash collected in 12 months, Feb 2026. More than 500,000 customers.	Reported, Fortune. It is cash collected, not ARR.
Qonto	EUR 4.4B (about $5B), Jan 2022. About 600,000 customers. 2025 income EUR 495M from one French report.	Value confirmed, income weak
Vanta	$4.15B, Jul 2025. More than $300M ARR and 16,000 customers, Apr 2026. No money layer.	Reported, Fortune

Counter-evidence: Vanta and Avoca passed $1B with no money layer. Both sell to customers who can pay far more per task than an Azerbaijani micro firm.

Small home markets

Company	Home market	Route	Value
Uzum	Uzbekistan, about 37M people	Marketplace, then bank and payments	$1.16B Mar 2024; $2.3B pre-money Mar 2026. 2025 revenue $691M, net profit $176M (company figures, unaudited)
Kaspi	Kazakhstan, about 20M	Payments, marketplace, bank	About $16B market cap, May 2026
Tabby	Saudi Arabia and UAE	Buy now, pay later	$1.5B Nov 2023; $6.5B Sep 2026 (confirmed)
Insider	Turkey, sold globally early	Marketing software	About $1.2B, Mar 2022
Picsart	Armenia, sold globally	Consumer app	More than $1B, Aug 2021
Alif	Tajikistan, about 10M	Fintech	About $100M, 2021. Nearest in size to Azerbaijan.

We found no Azerbaijani company at or near $1B. That rests on a few searches, so it is not proof.

Warnings

- **Bench:** shut down abruptly on 27 Dec 2024, then was bought by Employer.com. It sold human bookkeeping with software.
- **Pilot:** $1.2B in March 2021 (confirmed). No priced round found since.
- **Sierra:** $15.8B in May 2026. Use $150M a year from February 2026. The $200M figure in our earlier documents rests on weak sources.

What is the same across the winners

1. **One narrow job for one clear buyer.** Avoca started with missed calls, Serval with IT tickets, Slash with sneaker resellers.
2. **Accountants are the buyer or the channel** in Pennylane, Basis and Rillet. Bookkeeping services with people inside are the ones that failed.
3. **A legal push helps.** Pennylane had French e-invoicing. Vanta had compulsory certificates.
4. **From a small home market, own the money flow or sell globally.** We found no exception.
5. **The smaller the customer, the more you need money flow.** Revenue per customer: Vanta about $18,750, Gusto about $2,000, Melio about $1,900, Qonto about $950, Omie about $600, NowAI at launch about $100 (our arithmetic).
6. **Agents need people.** Sierra uses forward-deployed engineers, and Wonderful had about 350 staff at $2B. DataSnipper is the smallest back-office company we found at $1B, at about 130.
7. **Investors price speed.** Serval went from $1B to $3B in 10 months, and Wonderful from $2B to $5B in 6. Most of these companies disclose no revenue.

Figures we deliberately left out

- Wonderful's $55M and $70M revenue, and its 650 staff (weak sources).
- Avoca's "eight figures" revenue and Mercury's $650M to $1B revenue (not confirmed).
- Thrive Holdings' $12B roll-up valuation (one unverified report, and a services business).
- Lovable's revenue at its first $1B round. The $100M claim did not hold, and one source says about $75M.
- Insider's $2.5B to $5B range and $200M revenue.
- Tide's revenue, Picsart's latest value and all staff counts in the regional group.